11.4 CSS Isolation in Razor Pages

In chapter 2, I briefly mentioned the Layout.cshtml.css file in the Shared folder, which contains CSS style declarations that are applied to the _Layout.cshtml file. I mentioned that the slightly odd name for the stylesheet is part of a convention used by CSS Isolation, which was introduced to Razor Pages in .Net 6. This section discusses what CSS isolation is and how it works.

First, have a look at the kind of problems CSS isolation is intended to mitigate. As you build a web application, you will generally place CSS style declarations in a global stylesheet that is referenced in the main layout file. That way, the declarations within the stylesheet are available to all pages that make use of the layout, whether they are needed in a specific page or not. As you continue to develop the application, new styles will be added that relate to specific pages or even sections. You might want to change the default font for a single page, for example, so you add a new CSS selector to your stylesheet that you can use to target elements on that page only and update the class attributes of the target elements accordingly. Your global stylesheet grows and grows. You find yourself relying more and more on your editor's search feature to locate the declaration for a particular style you might want to update. Over time, you forget which style declarations are actually being used and which can safely be removed.

Let's say, for example, you want to apply some CSS to the `h5` headings on the City page. They are currently targeted by an event handler that listens for a click event and populates the modal dialog with the property details. Typically, users expect the cursor to change from an arrow to a pointing finger when they hover over clickable elements on a web page. So it makes sense to apply the `cursor:pointer` rule to all the `h5` elements on the page. You don't want to apply this change to all other `h5` elements in the